

email, name and feedback for a feedback page, or email, name and message for a contact page. Or you might need their personal details for registering an account.

For all these situations and more Django has as the forms framework. Django's form framework allows you to not only create such forms for displaying on your website, but also supports creating automatically creating forms for existing models in your database.

Django forms framework handles cleaning and validating the data entered by the user, and provides the facility to customise this validation to include your own logic.

Authentication

Another useful and powerful framework that Django includes out of the box is the Authentication framework. This framework includes models for Users and Groups, and includes a permissions system that allows administrators to control what users, and what groups are allowed to do what kinds of tasks.

These systems are flexible enough to apply to any kind of content that you create with Django. For instance you could create a CMS where regular users can create and edit articles, but not delete them, where they can create tags, but not edit or delete them, and where they can apply categories to articles but not create new categories.

You can also create your own kinds of permissions. For instance on a website that charges for viewing some kinds of articles you might want to add a permission to view articles and only give that permission to users that belong to the group of paying members.

Of course you will still need to check for this permission before displaying those articles; that is not automatically handled as Django has no way of knowing what your permission implies just by what you name it.

We won't be doing much with the permissions framework in our CMS, but it is an important component in any good CMS, and we are getting it for free by using Django.

Emails

Whether you want to notify users of new articles, or want to send a newsletter or to share articles with others via email, there is a good use case for having the ability to send emails from your CMS.

By combining the ability to generate PDF files with the ability to send emails, you can even add the ability to send articles to a user's Kindle device